Muncie Policy Memo

Civic Meeting Report

Muncie City Council, November 2, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Xbk7upBQyQ0
Publication Date	2026-11-03T01:31:06Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Muncie Common Council Meeting Summary

Date: November 3, 2026
Body: Muncie Common Council

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Public Hearing on Ordinances 23-26 and 26-26 00:00:00
- **Summary of Discussion:**
  - **Ordinance 23-26:** An ordinance to vacate an alley in Heath Place Addition. Mara Hoff (representing property owner Zach Osborne) testified that the alleyway is unimproved (partially gravel and grass) and dead-ends into a building, noting that its vacation would not hinder parcel access and would allow business expansion. She noted this was a second hearing due to a typo in the initial notice. No public opposition was heard.
  - **Ordinance 26-26:** Additional appropriations for the Fire Department EMS. No public comments were offered. The hearing was adjourned to reconvene for the regular meeting at 7:00 PM 00:02:02.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Regular meeting called to order on November 3, 2026, by the presiding officer 00:14:45.
- **Attendance:**
  - *Members Present:* Councilman Dishman, President Green, and other council members (exact roll call responses noted as present 00:18:12).
  - *Members Absent:* None explicitly noted as absent during roll call.
  - *Presiding Officer:* Council President Green.

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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
  - Pledge of Allegiance led by Councilman Dishman 00:14:57.
  - Invocation delivered 00:15:14.
  - Moments of silence held for Jeanette Presley (community advocate/peer recovery coach) and Chris Wilson (local athlete) 00:15:40, 00:17:14.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Motion made, seconded, and approved by voice vote / roll call for prior meeting minutes 00:18:27.

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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:18:45 **Committee Report: Tax Abatements & Economic Incentives**
  - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Council leadership / City records review.
  - *Deliberation Summary:* Addressed prior questions regarding city and county tax abatements. Listed city abatements granted in 2021/recent years (including Calimat Parologic, Cardinal Housing, Phillips Pattern, JRF Management, TWG Muncie, and Gilman Real Estate). Addressed questions regarding the Dana property, confirming no record of a Muncie City Council tax abatement granted to Dana, though noting state conditional tax credits and training grants. Mentioned Kilgore Avenue Pure Energy Park redevelopment incentives.
  - *Action & Disposition:* Information presented; no formal board action required.
- 00:23:39 **Ordinance 23-26: Ordinance to Vacate Alley in Heath Place Addition**
  - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Mara Hoff (Deferber, representing property owner Zach Osborne).
  - *Deliberation Summary:* Re-presented details regarding the unimproved 60-foot wide alley (Colmett Street). Affidavits from adjacent property owners indicated no objections. Councilman Dishman noted he inspected the site and supported passage.
  - *Item-Specific Public Input:* None additional.

    - *Action & Disposition:* Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously / Yes votes recorded) 00:26:24.
- 00:24:41 **Ordinance 24-26: Ordinance Fixing Salaries of Elected Officials for 2027**
    - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Matt Wigley, City Controller.
    - *Deliberation Summary:* Controller Wigley noted a clerical error regarding the city clerk's figure, proposing an amendment to adjust the mayor/clerk figures (specifically adjusting the city clerk figure to $24,999.64). An amendment was moved, seconded, and approved by roll call 00:28:31.
    - *Action & Disposition:* Ordinance 24-26 introduced and approved as amended by Roll Call 00:29:04.
- 00:29:26 **Ordinance 25-26: Ordinance Fixing Maximum Salaries of Appointed Officers & Employees for 2027**
    - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Matt Wigley, City Controller.
    - *Deliberation Summary:* Extensive council and public debate regarding un-funded line items, human rights department salaries, and administrative positions. Amendments were moved and seconded to zero out the salary lines for the Deputy Mayor and City Engineer 00:36:43. A motion to table the ordinance was subsequently made due to concerns over negotiations and unaddressed questions, and approved by roll call 00:45:45.
    - *Item-Specific Public Input:* Nate Burgess (AFSCME 36-56 president) spoke regarding union raises and lack of timely outreach from the administration 00:38:25. Residents voiced frustration over transparency and handling of departmental salary allocations 00:40:38.
    - *Action & Disposition:* Tabled by Roll Call 00:46:24.
- 00:47:44 **Ordinance 26-26: Additional Appropriations for Fire Department EMS Overtime**
    - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Chief Dan Burford, Muncie Fire Department.
    - *Deliberation Summary:* Chief Burford requested an additional appropriation of $500,000 for overtime, to be funded out of EMS revenue (Fund 104) rather than the general fund. Explanations included severe weather events, historic flooding, high volume of personnel in paramedic school, extended sick leave, workers' comp, and military leave. Council discussed hiring processes, local recruitment, and EMS fee write-off policies.
    - *Item-Specific Public Input:* Rick Yanzer questioned total overtime spending and high ambulance fees `[00:48:05, 055:00]`. AFSCME representatives voiced strong support for funding public safety personnel 00:59:52.
    - *Action & Disposition:* Approved by Roll Call `[1]:00:`25.
- 00:48:48 **Ordinance 27-26: Amending Section 31.13 of Muncie City Code (Board of Public Works and Safety / Human Rights)**
    - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Dantanya Bats (Human Rights Director) / Daisy Dale (Human Rights Board member).

    - *Deliberation Summary:* Presented to establish consistent protected classes across all city departments, promote legal compliance, reduce liability, and improve public accountability. City Attorney John Monahan and the Board of Works assisted in drafting with no opposition.
    - *Item-Specific Public Input:* Daisy Dale spoke in favor of adoption, noting multi-departmental review and lack of opposition from the Board of Works 01:03:32.
    - *Action & Disposition:* Approved by Roll Call 01:04:10.
- 01:04:27 **Resolution 15-26: Industry Neighborhood Association Youth Center Committee**
    - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Council member / Industry Neighborhood Association.
    - *Deliberation Summary:* The sponsor explained that after consulting with the Industry Neighborhood Association constituents, the association instructed that the resolution be withdrawn to allow further direct discussions with the mayor regarding promised funding.
    - *Action & Disposition:* Withdrawn by the sponsor 01:06:24.
- 01:09:01 **Resolution 16-26: Continuation of Local Disaster Emergency**
    - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Presiding Officer / City Administration.
    - *Deliberation Summary:* Consenting to the continuation and extension of the local disaster emergency originally declared on August 13, 2026. Minimal discussion.
    - *Action & Disposition:* Approved by Roll Call 01:09:43.
- 01:10:03 **Resolution 17-26: Interlocal Agreement Concerning 2026 Justice Assistance Grant Program**
    - *Sponsor / Presenter:* City Administration / Finance.
    - *Deliberation Summary:* Addressed approval of the JAG interlocal agreement. Due to the absence of administrative finance representatives to answer questions, council members discussed procedural options.
    - *Action & Disposition:* Motion to table raised 01:11:07. Ongoing discussions occurred regarding prior information requests and accountability from the controller's office.

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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 01:22:31 **Rick Yanzer:** Spoke on historical context of Muncie, community violence, and the need for neighborhood-focused policing rather than administrative luxuries.
- 01:25:19 **Wayne Scafe:** Addressed procedural fairness during prior public comments, criticized council handling of missed administrative reporting deadlines, and supported city workers.
- 01:28:41 **Nathan Burgess (AFSCME 36-56 President):** Voiced deep disappointment regarding council votes on salary/union matters, presented documentation disputing administration claims regarding the timeline of union negotiations, and criticized administrative leadership.

- 01:31:37 **Paul Partizana:** Reminded residents about voting rights and election day preparation, encouraging civic participation.
- 01:40:03 **Dr. Chip Taylor:** Expressed concern over administrative stonewalling regarding accounting inquiries, urged the council to maintain scheduled investigative meetings, and suggested publicizing board and commission vacancies to attract more applicants.
- 01:34:03 **John Wargo:** Expressed frustration over the rejection of provisions affecting city workers, emphasizing the dedication of municipal boots-on-the-ground employees.
- 01:36:58 **Courtney Marsh:** Thanked the council for moment-of-silence recognitions, highlighted recent South Side Neighborhood Association community events honoring local heroes, and encouraged voting.

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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - Reminder of the upcoming special meeting scheduled for November 16, 2026, pending the delivery of requested financial and accounting answers from the controller's office by the end of the week.
- **Adjournment:** Official adjournment disposition and time: Approved by voice vote at approximately 01:45:49 (8:30 PM noted in transcript).

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